News & Nonsense

August, 2026 **Part - 1**

DAU's Next Chapter: A Conversation with the Director

Dhirubhai Ambani University (DAU) is undergoing one of the most significant transformations in recent years. A recent conversation with the Director shed light on the university's vision for this next phase.

The transition from DA-IICT to Dhirubhai Ambani University is centered around creating a multidisciplinary institution, with the School of Technology collaborating with the Schools of Law, Finance, Design, and Health Sciences. The institute is also responding to the AI revolution with an AI minor being developed for all branches.

Complementing these academic developments are several major infrastructure projects across the campus. A new five-floor classroom complex is under construction, initially housing four large classrooms with a capacity of around 130–140 students each, with plans to expand to ten classrooms. A six-floor building for faculty offices and research labs will be constructed between the CEP and the Lab Building, with completion expected around late 2028. The Director stated that the CEP and LT-2/LT-3 will be air-conditioned by next year.

Addressing the university's financial planning, the Director deemed the recent ~10% fee hike necessary to match rising operational costs, upgrade facilities, and retain top-tier faculty. He noted that the fee structure may be locked for each incoming batch and not increase during their tenure.

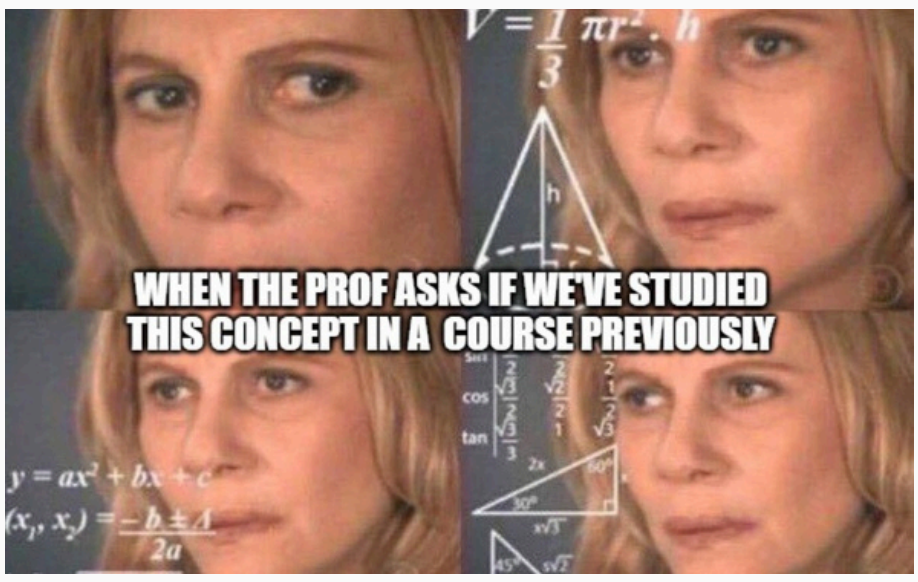
The interview also highlighted several academic reforms. According to the Director, the perceived shortage of electives is a distribution issue rather than a capacity issue, as total elective seats outnumber requirements by 30%. High-demand courses such as Machine Learning and Cloud Computing are increasingly treated by students as mandatory core subjects, and the administration plans to offer these courses in both semesters. He also expressed concern over students choosing electives based on "herd mentality" and "easy grading" rather than genuine academic interest. To improve academic oversight, a new "Class Committee" system comprising faculty and students is being introduced to oversee course evaluations and prevent grading that is either too harsh or too lenient. The Director also believes there is an "over-reliance" on CPI, noting that companies are increasingly prioritizing projects, communication skills, and presentation skills over academic grades. He plans to standardize CPI across branches such as ICT and MnC with the help of institute-wide courses.

The institute encourages "flipped classrooms," where theoretical learning takes place outside the classroom through videos and learning materials, while classroom time is dedicated to collaborative problem-solving. A new category of "Teaching Fellows" is also being introduced to assist students and bridge the gap created by the shortage of traditional Ph.D. and Master's teaching assistants. The institute is also bringing in external industry professionals to offer skill-based certificate programs.

Beyond academics, the university is also strengthening its industry outreach. DAU is establishing placement nodes in major hubs such as Bangalore, Hyderabad, Kolkata, and Pune to maintain continuous relationships with companies.

The discussion also touched upon the Rural Internship program. The Director acknowledged that the traditional Rural Internship had lost its efficacy, leading to the establishment of a "Community Impact Lab." DAU has adopted five local villages where students will work on long-term projects, with solutions prototyped on campus before being deployed in the villages.. This will create a more meaningful and sustained model of community engagement.

In conclusion, the Director urged students to make the most of their four years at DAU. He emphasized that while the university will continue providing opportunities and industry connections, meaningful growth ultimately depends on students actively engaging in clubs, projects, and with their peers.



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We'll be back with Part -2

IN THE MEANTIME

Press Club

News & Nonsense

August, 2026 **Part - 1**

Timetable Troubles : Iss baar 7 baje paar

This semester's timetable has left students juggling more than just their coursework. Classes scattered across the day have left awkward one-hour gaps in their wake, breaking up the schedule for students and faculty alike. The Student Body has been in talks with the administration over the issue, and here's where things currently stand.

The core problem, as students have pointed out, isn't a lack of free time — it's how that time is spread out. Administration data shows nearly 45% of total study time is technically free based on course credits, but scattered one-hour breaks make that time far less usable than the number suggests.

The Student Body's proposed fix is a modular structure: core lectures in the morning and labs in the afternoon for first and second years, with third and fourth years following a similar pattern of core and elective lectures paired with labs, the order adjusted between year groups to balance venue load across campus.

The current schedule was finalized earlier this year in a meeting with Dean AP, Director ,and Dean Students, and the administration has confirmed that no changes will be made mid-semester. Classes are already underway, and visiting faculty schedules are locked in.

Part of the complexity comes down to numbers: this year saw a net increase of five to six electives, adding pressure on scheduling and room allocation. For now, existing CEP rooms and Lecture Theatres are sufficient if slots are properly segregated, and the ongoing construction of Lecture Theatre 4, expected to be ready by next year, should ease capacity constraints further down the line.
So what's next? The Student Body will be rolling out a Google Form survey across all batches to gather structured feedback. The survey is scheduled to launch after five to ten days, once students have had time to settle into the new routine. Results will then be compiled and taken to the Dean and Timetable Committee, with the Student Body pushing for a streamlined modular schedule to take effect next semester.

Whether that push pays off remains to be seen. For now, the ball is in the students' court, so when that survey link drops, fill it out.
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Press Club